

DUSTRUNNER · DESIGN DECISION RECORD

DustRunner TRL 2 review decisions

Open Hardware Portfolio · amishchadha.com

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	DRN-DDR-001	Version	0.1
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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/dustrunner		
Source	docs/decisions/0001-trl2-review-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Record Amish's decisions on the TRL 2 review items and the items that remain open

0001: TRL 2 review decisions

- **Date:** 2026-09-25
- **Status:** accepted for items D1 to D12; item O1 remains proposed

■ Context

The TRL 2 review note (docs/REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-25, /populate) listed ten items as "Proposed, awaiting Amish", and the design precis DRN-PRC-001 v0.2 and problem statement DRN-PRB-001 v0.2 listed further design choices and open questions, each with options. On 2026-09-25 Amish reviewed the review points for every portfolio repo and wrote: "proceed with all of your recommendations across all batches. Make sure we don't proceed to TRL 4 on any of them." Every item that carried a recommendation is therefore decided in favor of that recommendation. Items without a recommendation stay open.

The same instruction approved three portfolio-wide decisions: SwapCell interface v0.3 adds a wake method for hosts without CAN, a charge-while-discharging mode and a latch vibration rating for vehicles; shared SwapCell packs are priced once and excluded from each dependent kit budget; and community designs pick co-design partners per area later. DustRunner does not use a SwapCell pack (D6), so the first two do not change this design.

■ Options considered

The options for each item are those listed in docs/REVIEW.md (session 2026-09-25, /populate), in DRN-PRC-001 v0.2 (Key design choices) and in DRN-PRB-001 v0.2 (Open questions).

■ Decision

Table 1. Decided items.

#	Item	Decision
D1	Scope	Option (a): one full-width robot per row, riding on the module frames of 1P portrait tables, rather than a smaller robot on the glass or a transfer cart between rows. The fit limit (short module edges free of clamps) stays in R4. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D2	Cleaning time	In the evening, after the array's output has dropped and before dew forms, gated by the humidity sensor; not at night or at dawn. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D3	Wind input	Option (a): a cup anemometer at the dock (about \$15), not a weather feed or a motor-current rule alone. It is BOM item 16. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D4	Charging	A 20 W panel at the dock charging the parked robot through spring contacts, not a panel on the robot. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D5	Traction	Both wheels driven on each end truck (belt-linked) and spring-preloaded hook rollers under the frame lip, pending a friction measurement. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D6	Battery	A 12.8 V 10 Ah LiFePO4 pack with BMS; no SwapCell pack, because DustRunner needs about a quarter of a SwapCell's energy at a quarter of its voltage. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D7	Reference row	Keep the 40 m, 20 kWp reference row (35 modules) for the requirements and the design case. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D8	R14 target	Restate R14 as "payback of 3 years or less on rows of 60 m or more", mid case, rather than keeping 3 years on the 40 m row or relaxing it to 5 years. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D9	Budget and wording	Keep <code>budget_usd</code> at \$500 for one robot and its dock, now including the anemometer. Keep the pitch. Reword the problem line to "up to 15 to 25% a month in the dusty season" in <code>project.yaml</code> and <code>README.md</code> . Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D10	First table format	1P portrait tables of 2,278 mm modules with 30 to 35 mm frames. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D11	End stops	Keep clamp-on mechanical end stops as the independent backstop to the IR sensors (R9). Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D12	Cleaning medium	A dry microfiber brush, with no water and no airflow stage; add airflow only if tests show that dust is re-deposited. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.

Table 2. Item that remains open (no recommendation was made).

#	Item	Status
O1	Pilot site and co-design partner: a solar pumping farm, a mini-grid operator or a university test array	Proposed, awaiting Amish (co-design partners to be picked per area later, as Amish directed for community designs)

■ Consequences

- `project.yaml` and `README.md`: the problem line reads "Soiling cuts output of PV arrays in dusty regions by up to 15 to 25% a month in the dusty season, and water for washing is scarce." The pitch and `budget_usd` (\$500) are unchanged.

- DRN-PRB-001, DRN-PRC-001 and DRN-REQ-001 are revised to v0.3. R14 is restated per D8; R13 keeps \$500 and now covers the robot, the dock and the anemometer. The key design choices in the precis are no longer "proposed".
- The BOM gains item 16 (dock anemometer, \$15), which brings the indicative total to exactly \$500 (DRN-CAL-001, I1), so R13 has no margin.
- The TRL 3 calculations (DRN-CAL-001) raise new questions about the operating wind limit, the wheel load at row entry and the budget margin. They are listed in docs/REVIEW.md as "Proposed, awaiting Amish"; this record does not decide them.
- TRL 4 is on hold by Amish's instruction. Nothing in this record authorizes building or testing.